Power BI Assignment: Publishing, Sharing, Workspaces and Security

Q1. Explain why publishing and sharing reports is considered more important than just building dashboards in Power BI Desktop.

Building dashboards in Power BI Desktop is only the first step. The real value comes when reports are published and shared with users who need the information for decision-making. Publishing allows reports to be accessed online, refreshed automatically, and viewed by multiple users. Without sharing, the insights remain limited to the report creator and cannot support collaboration or business decisions.

Q2. Define Power BI Service and explain its role in comparison to Power BI Desktop in the reporting lifecycle.

Power BI Service is the cloud-based online platform used to publish, share, collaborate, and manage Power BI reports and dashboards. Power BI Desktop is used to create reports and data models, while Power BI Service is used to publish, distribute, and manage them.

Q3. What does publishing a report mean in Power BI? List any two outcomes that occur after a report is published.

Publishing a report means transferring a report from Power BI Desktop to Power BI Service so that it can be accessed online. Two outcomes are: (1) the report becomes available in Power BI Service, and (2) users can view and share the report online.

Q4. List and explain the steps involved in publishing a report from Power BI Desktop to Power BI Service in the correct sequence.

1. Create and save the report. 2. Sign in to Power BI. 3. Click Publish. 4. Select a workspace. 5. Confirm publishing. 6. Verify the report in Power BI Service. 7. Share the report or create dashboards.

Q5. Differentiate between Report and Dashboard in Power BI based on structure and usage.

A Report contains multiple pages and supports detailed analysis. A Dashboard is a single-page summary created in Power BI Service and is used for quick monitoring of KPIs and important metrics.

Q6. Explain the difference between Direct Report Sharing, Workspace Access, and Power BI Apps. Also mention one use case for each.

Direct Report Sharing: Share a specific report with selected users; use case: sharing a sales report with a manager. Workspace Access: Users collaborate inside a workspace; use case: BI team development. Power BI Apps: Package and distribute content to large audiences; use case: company-wide reporting.

Q7. Describe the four workspace roles available in Power BI and explain how access control is managed using these roles.

Admin: full control. Member: create, edit, and publish content. Contributor: create and modify content but cannot manage access. Viewer: view-only access. Access control is managed by assigning users the appropriate role based on responsibilities.

Q8. Why are Power BI Apps considered more secure and scalable than direct sharing?

Power BI Apps provide centralized distribution, easier management, consistent content delivery, view-only access for users, and better governance. They can be distributed to large groups efficiently, making them more scalable and secure than direct sharing.

Q9. Explain Row-Level Security (RLS) in Power BI. How does RLS ensure that different users see different data using the same report?

RLS restricts data access based on user roles. Different users can open the same report, but Power BI filters the data according to rules assigned to their role, ensuring each user sees only authorized information.

Q10. Discuss any three risks if reports are shared without Apps, workspace roles, or RLS, and explain how best practices help prevent them.

Risks include unauthorized data access, poor governance with multiple report versions, and accidental modifications or misuse. Best practices such as RLS, workspace roles, and Power BI Apps help secure data, control permissions, and maintain a single source of truth.